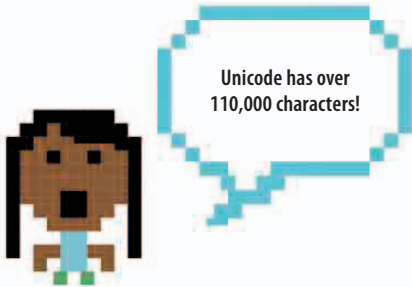


Unicode

As computers across the world began to share data, the limits of ASCII began to show. Thousands of characters used in hundreds of languages had to be represented, so a universal standard called Unicode was agreed on.



▷ International code

Unicode represents all the languages of the world. For example, the Arabic characters are represented in the range 0600–06FF.



▷ Unicode characters

Unicode characters are represented by their hexadecimal value, which appears as a series of letters and numbers (see pp.182–183). Each character has its own code. More characters are added all the time, and there are some unusual ones, such as a mini umbrella.



2602



2EC6



08A2



0036



0974



004D



2702



A147

REMEMBER

Hexadecimals

Hexadecimal numbers have a base of 16. Ordinary decimal numbers are used for 0 to 9, and the values 10–15 are represented by the letters A to F. Each hexadecimal number has an equivalent binary value.

The Unicode value of ë as hexadecimal

The same value as binary

ë = 00EB = 11100111

▽ Unicode in Python

Unicode can be used to display special characters in Python. Simply type a string containing a Unicode character code.

Putting “\u” before the hexadecimal code tells the computer this is Unicode

```
>>> 'Zo\u00EB'
'Zoë'
```

The code is translated into the character “ë”